



CES 2006, Panasonic showed off a fuel-cell powered laptop that had enough juice to last nearly 20 hours at a size that was just slightly bigger than current battery packs. Throw *that* into an XPS and international flights won't be so long and boring any more, will they?

Stuff It

Most of us here at *Digit* have invested in 250 GB hard disks for our homes—they're so affordable now! Of course, figuring out what to put into that much space does take some thinking. Storage is becoming cheaper by the day, and huge hard disks will have lost their ooh value quite soon.

In May 2005, Hitachi announced its Deskstar 7K500, which holds a respectable 500 GB of data using the standard recording technique that all hard disks use. But this is probably the limit for hard disk recording—no more data can be stuffed into those disks without overhauling the way data is recorded. So they overhauled it.

The Hitachi Travelstar 5K160

With their revolutionary new Perpendicular Storage technology, Hitachi have managed to squeeze more bits onto hard disk platters, opening the doors to a world where hard disks get smaller in physical size while remaining bloated enough to hoard your data ten times over. While bits today "lie down" on hard disk platters, occupying more space, the perpendicular technique stands them up, allowing for more data to fit into the same area of the hard disk.

The Travelstar 5K160 is Hitachi's first 2.5 inch drive with a capacity of 160 GB—60 GB more than the current longitudinal storage disk—and comes with new "travel head" technology that will double the drive's reliability. They will now turn their attention to the smaller 1.8 inch to see how much they can get onto those—will we see 100 GB drives on our cell phones soon?

The 5K160 will launch later this year, and will cost around \$269 (Rs 11,500).

URL: www.hitachigst.com

The Swiss Army Drive

Standard USB drive not doing enough for you? Get your hands on this Swiss Army knife that

packs in all the goodies essential for survival in the wild: a red LED light for night-time jaunts, a ball-point pen to, well, write stuff, a knife, a pair of scissors, a file with a screwdriver, a key-ring, and a USB flash drive! You can choose from 256 MB, 512 MB and 1 GB, and the drive's detachable if you want to be boring as well.

Order it from: www.thinkgeek.com/gadgets/tools/6b3b/

Mine, All Mine!

When you're on the road with your laptop, you need to (a) keep other people's noses out of your business, and (b) ensure that your business stays well clear of others' noses. These two USB devices will make sure that the things happening around your laptop will stay in the vicinity of your laptop.

The USB Flex Light

Want to work on your laptop on a night-time journey without bothering your fellow passengers? Just stick this flexible light into your laptop's USB port to illuminate the keyboard or any surrounding area. Its flexible neck lets you change its position to best suit you. It drains very little power from the battery, so is ideal for the road warrior who cares.

URL: www.iogear.com

The FlyFan USB Fan

This one is the ultimate tool to make your fellow travellers burn—both in jealousy and in the heat. Perfect for unforgiving summer travel, connect this fan to your laptop's USB port to sit back and enjoy a steady stream of cooling air and a view of the others wiping the sweat off their foreheads.

URL: www.kensington.com

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